

Word family: **reliable / reliably / reliability / unreliable / unreliably / unreliability**

Base word: reliable

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **reliable** (adj.) — 可靠的；可信賴的

* **reliably** (adv.) — 可靠地；穩定地

* **reliability** (n.) — 可靠性；可信賴程度

* **unreliable** (adj.) — 不可靠的；不可信賴的

* **unreliably** (adv.) — 不可靠地

* **unreliability** (n.) — 不可靠性

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **reliable person**

* **reliable worker**

* **reliable source**

* **reliable information**

* **reliable evidence**

* **reliable method**

* **reliable system**

* **reliable car**

* **reliable service**

* **reliable results**

* **high reliability**

* **reliability of a system**

* **unreliable source**

* **unreliable narrator**

Meaning in this passage

> Of course, my grades improved, but more importantly, I became calmer and more **reliable**.

Here, **reliable** means:

someone other people can depend on to do what they are supposed to do — 可靠的；值得信賴的

The speaker became better at managing time, meeting responsibilities, and finishing work properly, so other people could depend on them more.

中文翻譯：

當然，我的成績的確進步了，但更重要的是，我變得更冷靜，也更**可靠**。

So here:

reliable person = 做事穩定、守承諾、能按時完成責任，因此別人可以放心依靠的人

1. **reliable person — 可靠的人；值得信賴的人**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I became calmer and more **reliable**.

我變得更冷靜，也更**可靠**。

Practice 2

> Kevin is very **reliable** and always finishes his work on time.

Kevin 很**可靠**，總是準時完成工作。

Practice 3

> We need someone **reliable** to lead the group.

我們需要一個**可靠的人**帶領小組。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliable = 做事穩定、值得信任，而且通常會按承諾完成應做的事****

2. **reliable worker / employee — 可靠的員工**

Practice 1

> She is a very **reliable employee**.

她是一名非常**可靠的員工**。

Practice 2

> A **reliable worker** can be trusted to meet deadlines.

可靠的員工可以被信任會按時完成工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliable worker = 工作表現穩定、守時、能完成責任的員工

3. **reliable friend / teammate** — 可靠的朋友 / 隊友

Practice 1

> He is a **reliable teammate** who never lets the group down.

他是一個**可靠的隊友**，從不拖累小組。

Practice 2

> I know I can depend on her because she is **reliable**.

我知道自己可以依靠她，因為她很**可靠**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliable friend/teammate = 在需要時可以信任和依靠的人

4. **reliable source** — 可靠來源

A major informational sense.

Practice 1

> Make sure you use a **reliable source**.

確保你使用**可靠來源**。

Practice 2

> The information came from a **reliable source**.

這些資料來自一個**可信來源**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliable source = 所提供資料通常準確、可信，可以合理依賴的來源

5. **reliable information** — 可靠資料；可信資訊

Practice 1

> We need **reliable information** before making a decision.

作決定前，我們需要**可靠資料**。

Practice 2

> It is difficult to find **reliable information** online.

在網上有時很難找到**可信的資訊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliable information = 準確度高、可以合理相信的資訊

6. **reliable evidence** — 可靠證據

Practice 1

> The claim was supported by **reliable evidence**.

這項說法有**可靠證據**支持。

Practice 2

> We should not reach a conclusion without **reliable evidence**.

沒有**可靠證據**，我們不應下結論。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliable evidence = 來源和方法可信，足以支持判斷的證據

7. **reliable method** — 可靠方法

Practice 1

> This is a **reliable method** for measuring progress.

這是一種量度進度的**可靠方法**。

Practice 2

> We need a more **reliable way** to collect the data.

我們需要一種更**可靠的方法**收集資料。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliable method = 能夠穩定產生可信結果的方法****

8. **reliable system — 可靠系統**

Practice 1

> The company needs a **reliable system** for storing files.

公司需要一套**可靠的系統**儲存檔案。

Practice 2

> A **reliable system** should work consistently.

一套**可靠的系統**應該能穩定運作。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliable system = 能夠穩定運作，而且很少出錯或故障的系統****

9. **reliable machine / car — 性能可靠的機器 / 汽車**

Practice 1

> This car is old but very **reliable**.

這輛車雖然舊，但非常**可靠**。

Practice 2

> We need a **reliable machine** for daily use.

我們需要一部適合日常使用、性能**可靠**的機器。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliable machine/car = 能穩定運作、不容易故障的機器或車輛****

10. ****reliable service — 穩定可靠的服務****

Practice 1

> The company provides a ****reliable delivery service****.

公司提供****可靠穩定的送貨服務****。

Practice 2

> Customers expect ****reliable service****.

顧客期望得到****可靠的服務****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliable service = 能夠持續按預期提供、不常中斷或出錯的服務****

11. ****reliable results — 可靠結果****

A major academic/scientific sense.

Practice 1

> The experiment produced ****reliable results****.

實驗得出了****可靠結果****。

Practice 2

> A larger sample may produce more ****reliable results****.

較大的樣本可能產生更****可靠的結果****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliable results = 在合理條件下重複時仍大致一致，因此值得信賴的結果****

12. **reliability (人的可靠程度) — 可靠程度 ; 可信賴性**

Practice 1

> Her **reliability** made her an important member of the team.

她的**可靠性**令她成為團隊的重要一員。

Practice 2

> Employers value punctuality and **reliability**.

僱主重視守時和**可靠性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliability = 某人是否能持續做到別人可以信賴和依靠的程度****

13. **reliability (系統 / 機器可靠性) — 可靠性 ; 穩定性**

Practice 1

> The **reliability of the system** has improved.

系統的**可靠性**有所提升。

Practice 2

> Engineers tested the product for **reliability**.

工程師測試產品的**可靠性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reliability = 系統、機器或服務持續正常運作而不出現故障的能力****

14. **reliability (研究 / 測量 : 信度) — 信度 ; 一致性**

A major technical sense in research and assessment.

Practice 1

> Researchers checked the **reliability of the questionnaire**.

研究人員檢查問卷的**信度**。

Practice 2

> The test has high **reliability**.

這項測試有很高的**信度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliability = 測量工具在重複使用時能否產生一致結果的程度

15. **reliably — 可靠地；穩定地**

Practice 1

> The system now works **reliably**.

系統現在能夠**穩定可靠地運作**。

Practice 2

> She **reliably** completes her work on time.

她總能**可靠地 / 一貫地**按時完成工作。

MCQ-ready definition:

reliably = 以穩定、可信而可以預期的方式

16. **unreliable person — 不可靠的人**

Practice 1

> He is talented but **unreliable**.

他很有才華，但**不可靠**。

Practice 2

> It's difficult to work with someone who is **unreliable**.

和一個**不可靠的人**共事很困難。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unreliable = 不能穩定履行承諾或責任，因此不能放心依賴****

17. ****unreliable source / information — 不可靠來源 / 資訊****

Practice 1

> The article relied on an ****unreliable source****.

文章依賴了一個****不可靠來源****。

Practice 2

> Be careful with ****unreliable information**** online.

要小心網上的****不可靠資訊****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unreliable information/source = 準確性或可信程度不足，不能放心依賴****

18. ****unreliable machine / service — 不穩定；容易出問題****

Practice 1

> The old printer is extremely ****unreliable****.

那部舊打印機非常****不可靠，經常出問題****。

Practice 2

> The internet connection has become ****unreliable****.

網絡連線變得****很不穩定****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****unreliable machine/service = 運作不穩定，經常故障、中斷或不能按預期工作****

19. ****unreliability — 不可靠性；不穩定性****

Practice 1

> The system's **unreliability** caused repeated delays.

系統的**不穩定性**造成多次延誤。

Practice 2

> His **unreliability** frustrated the whole team.

他的**不可靠**令整個團隊很沮喪。

MCQ-ready definition:

unreliability = 不能穩定地做到應有表現或履行承諾的特質

20. **unreliable narrator** — 不可靠敘述者

A major literary term.

Practice 1

> The novel is told by an **unreliable narrator**.

小說由一名**不可靠敘述者**講述。

Practice 2

> Readers gradually realize that the narrator is **unreliable**.

讀者逐漸意識到敘述者的說法**不完全可信**。

MCQ-ready definition:

unreliable narrator = 所提供的敘述可能因偏見、記憶、欺騙或理解有限而不能完全相信的敘述者

Important distinction 1: **reliable** vs **responsible**

Very relevant to your passage.

reliable

other people can depend on you.

responsible

you behave sensibly and accept your duties.

A responsible person is often reliable, but the concepts are not identical.

> reliable = **別人可以放心依靠你**

> responsible = **你有責任感、會做好自己應做的事**

Important distinction 2: **reliable vs trustworthy**

reliable

can be depended on to perform consistently.

trustworthy

can be trusted to be honest and behave properly.

> reliable employee

> 做事穩定可靠的員工

> trustworthy person

> 誠實可信的人

Someone can be honest but disorganized, making them **trustworthy but not very reliable**.

Important distinction 3: **reliable vs dependable**

These are very close.

dependable

especially emphasizes that you can count on someone.

reliable

broader and works naturally for:

* people,

* machines,

* information,

- * methods,
- * results.

> reliable source 

> dependable source possible, but less typical.

Important distinction 4: **reliable vs consistent**

consistent

behaves or performs similarly over time.

reliable

performs consistently **well enough to be depended on**.

Consistency alone can be bad:

> consistently late

is consistent but definitely not reliable.

Important distinction 5: **reliable vs accurate**

accurate

correct.

reliable

consistently dependable.

A measuring instrument can produce very consistent results but still be systematically wrong.

So scientifically:

reliability $\neq$ accuracy

Important distinction 6: **reliable vs valid**

Especially important in research.

reliability

results are consistent.

validity

the tool actually measures what it is supposed to measure.

A test can be reliable without being valid.

For example, a badly calibrated scale could repeatedly give the same wrong reading.

Important distinction 7: **reliable source vs authoritative source**

reliable source

information is generally trustworthy.

authoritative source

has recognized expertise or official standing.

An authoritative source is often reliable, but the two ideas are not identical.

Important distinction 8: **reliable result vs correct result**

correct

the answer is right.

reliable

the method/result is consistently dependable.

One lucky correct answer does not prove reliability.

Important distinction 9: **reliable machine vs durable machine**

reliable

works when needed without frequent failures.

durable

physically lasts a long time.

A machine can be durable but unreliable if it lasts for years yet frequently malfunctions.

Important distinction 10: **reliable service vs good service**

good service

broadly high quality.

reliable service

particularly consistent and dependable.

A service may be friendly but unreliable if it frequently arrives late.

Important distinction 11: **reliable vs available**

available

can be accessed or used.

reliable

works consistently when accessed.

Something can be available all the time but perform unreliably.

Important distinction 12: **reliability in research**

For academic English:

> **reliability = consistency**

A measure with high reliability tends to give similar results under comparable conditions.

Do not automatically translate it as everyday ****可靠**** when working in statistics or research methodology; ****信度**** is usually the more precise Traditional Chinese technical term.

Important distinction 13: ****unreliable narrator****

This does ****not**** necessarily mean the narrator is deliberately lying.

They may be unreliable because of:

- * limited knowledge,
- * poor memory,
- * bias,
- * misunderstanding,
- * self-deception,
- * deliberate dishonesty.

So:

****unreliable ≠ necessarily dishonest****

Family-extension note

****Reliable**** has one coherent semantic core:

****able to be depended on because performance, behaviour, or information is consistently trustworthy****

That branches into:

1. ****people****

- * reliable friend
- * reliable worker

2. ****information****

- * reliable source
- * reliable evidence

3. ****methods/results****

- * reliable method
- * reliable results

4. **machines/systems**

- * reliable car
- * reliable service

5. **technical measurement**

- * reliability = consistency / 信度

6. **negative family**

- * unreliable
- * unreliability

7. **literary specialist use**

- * unreliable narrator

For your passage, the exact branch is:

reliable = someone who manages responsibilities consistently enough that other people can depend on them

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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reliable (person)	可靠的 ; 值得信賴的	dependable person	
reliable worker	可靠的員工	consistent responsibility	
reliable teammate	可靠的隊友	can be counted on	
reliable source	可靠來源	trustworthy information	
reliable information	可靠資訊	credible content	
reliable evidence	可靠證據	dependable evidence	
reliable method	可靠方法	consistent method	
reliable system	可靠系統	stable operation	
reliable car	性能可靠的車	rarely fails	
reliable service	穩定可靠的服務	dependable delivery	
reliable results	可靠結果	consistent findings	
reliability (person)	可靠性	dependability	
reliability (machine)	可靠性 ; 穩定性	operational consistency	

reliability (research) 信度	measurement consistency	
reliably	可靠地；穩定地	consistently
unreliable (person)	不可靠的	cannot depend on
unreliable source	不可靠來源	doubtful information
unreliable system	不穩定系統	inconsistent operation
unreliability	不可靠性	lack of dependability
unreliable narrator	不可靠敘述者	narration cannot be fully trusted

For your original sentence

> Of course, my grades improved, but more importantly, I became calmer and more ****reliable****.

Here:

****reliable**** = 因為我開始懂得管理時間、按時完成工作和處理責任，所以別人可以更放心地依靠我

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當然，我的成績的確進步了，但更重要的是，我變得更冷靜，也更****可靠****。

The cleanest contrast is:

> ****responsible**** = 有責任感，會做好自己應做的事

> ****trustworthy**** = 誠實可信

> ****consistent**** = 表現穩定、一致

> ****reliable**** = ****因為表現一貫穩定，所以別人可以放心依靠****

That last idea—****“people can count on me”****—is the exact shade of meaning in your passage.